

Christian Sean Bulloss

cbulloss@gmail.com

(540) 842-0377

Youngsville, NC

cbulloss.dev 

Summary

Hands-on Engineering Manager with 8+ years building platforms in regulated domains (aviation, finance, government). I lead through a balance of technical depth and people leadership: setting architectural direction, scoping and derisking projects with product partners, growing engineers into the next level, and defending quality standards even under delivery pressure. Track record of delivering high-volume, high-availability, mission-critical applications.

Technical Skills

Primary: Java (Spring Boot), React, TypeScript, AWS (CDK, ECS/Fargate, RDS), DataDog

Supporting: .NET, Node.js, Python, GCP, Docker, CI/CD, Redis

Leadership Tools: SLO definition, incident command, blameless postmortems, engineering metrics, project scoping & derisking, coaching & performance management, career frameworks, AI-assisted development workflows

Education

Virginia Tech

B.S. Business Information Technology – Decision Support Systems

May 2014

Work History

ForeFlight

Engineering Manager

Feb 2025 - Present

Austin, TX (Remote)

Lead a full-stack engineering team delivering mission-critical aviation applications — flight logging, checklists, airport pricing, pilot community features, and more — to 200K+ monthly users across mobile and web clients.

People & Delivery

- ▶ Manage 7 engineers across IC levels; promoted three during tenure (two to Senior roles). Authored level-specific responsibility expectations under director's guidance to make the company's coarse leveling rubric actionable, then used deliberate skill-stretching assignments and targeted coaching to land those promotion cases
- ▶ Built engineering metrics dashboard integrating GitHub and Jira APIs to surface PR cycle times, contribution patterns, and sprint velocity — used the data to identify an early underperformance trend on the team and turn it around through structured coaching rather than escalation, restoring team trust and individual velocity
- ▶ Develop tech-lead capabilities in senior engineers by handing off project planning, timeline ownership, and architectural decisions — staying close enough to surface slippage upward, far enough back to let engineers grow into scope
- ▶ Partner with Product Management on a portfolio of 4-6 concurrent projects (3-6 months each) — scoping, derisking, and resourcing for both delivery and engineer growth. Recent example: steered the referral discount system from a 6-month estimate to 3-month delivery by deferring internal admin tooling post-launch; feature now drives organic user growth in the Logbook app

Platform Reliability & Architecture

- ▶ Define and maintain SLOs across 8 microservices, sustaining 99.99% platform uptime
- ▶ Lead incident response and blameless postmortems; deliver root-cause analysis and systemic remediation to prevent recurrence
- ▶ Set architectural direction on projects requiring it and remain active in solutioning across the team's stack

AI-Assisted Engineering Leadership

- ▶ Designed a custom architectural PR-review workflow that evaluates pull requests from a feature-level, system-design perspective rather than the line-level nits typical of off-the-shelf AI review tools; piloted on the team and continuing to refine based on real PR outcomes
- ▶ Drove early adoption of Claude Code on the team through a structured pilot program, shaping how engineers integrate AI into their workflow before broader company rollout
- ▶ Held the line on engineering quality when AI-generated work threatened production stability: identified architectural failures in AI-generated prototypes (e.g., local-filesystem persistence in a production candidate) and reinforced the standard that production code originates from and is owned by engineers, not prompt outputs

ForeFlight

Software Engineer / Senior Software Engineer

Sep 2022 - Feb 2025

Austin, TX (Remote)

Full-stack aviation platform development (Promoted to Senior Software Engineer January 2024)

- ▶ Architected flight logging platform serving 200K+ monthly users with regulatory compliance reporting for FAA, EASA, and Transport Canada certification requirements
- ▶ Engineered full-stack architecture with React frontend, Express middleware, and Spring Boot backend using reactive programming for high-volume data processing
- ▶ Modernized infrastructure from EC2/CloudFormation to Fargate/CDK, implementing automated deployment pipelines and cloud-native architecture patterns
- ▶ Built scalable analytics engine processing flight entries for real-time currency tracking, route analysis, and aviation training progress monitoring

- ▶ Grew into team leadership during this period — established mentorship practices and on-call rotation participation that informed transition to management

TigerRisk Partners, LLC

Application Developer / QA Automation Engineer

Oct 2020 - Sep 2022

Remote

Full-stack development and quality assurance for insurance technology solutions

- ▶ Delivered enterprise insurance applications using .NET stack (C#, ASP.NET Core, Angular, TypeScript) while contributing to agile planning and user story implementation
- ▶ Modernized legacy web API from .NET Framework to .NET 6, improving performance and maintainability across insurance analytics platform
- ▶ Established comprehensive testing framework combining automated UI testing (Cypress) with API validation, integrating security scanning into CI/CD pipeline
- ▶ Served as Scrum Master for cross-functional team, facilitating agile ceremonies and removing development blockers while maintaining development responsibilities

Ipreo US, LLC (now part of S&P Global)

Software Engineer, QA Engineer

May 2016 - July 2017

Raleigh, NC

Financial technology development with emphasis on automated testing innovation

- ▶ Built full-stack financial applications while pioneering test automation improvements including randomized data generation and page object model implementation
- ▶ Balanced development responsibilities with comprehensive quality assurance, creating systematic approaches to requirements analysis and test documentation

Harmonia Holdings Group, LLC

Software Engineer

Oct 2014 - May 2016

Blacksburg, VA

Government contracting software development emphasizing process excellence

- ▶ Delivered mission-critical software solutions in highly regulated environment, mastering rigorous documentation standards and compliance requirements
- ▶ Innovated automated testing approaches by independently developing REST API test harness, improving testing efficiency and reliability

Additional Experiences

Law Enforcement & Public Safety

Aug '17 - Oct '20

Police Officer / Public Safety Officer

Operational leadership experience in high-stakes, time-critical environments; built incident-command instincts that translate directly to engineering incident response and on-call leadership.

Blacksburg Volunteer Rescue Squad

Feb '11 - Jun '16

2nd Lt. IT / Volunteer EMT — Directed IT strategy, incident command, 8,000+ volunteer hours

Instrument Rated Private Pilot

Boy Scouts of America: Eagle Scout